



Inspection Report

Morgan City Petting Zoo
725 Myrtle St
Morgan City, LA 70380

Customer ID: **7257**
Certificate: **72-C-0171**
Site: 001
Morgan City Petting Zoo

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION
Date: 01-SEP-2026

3.27(b)

Facilities, outdoor.

There are eleven guinea pigs housed in the large red barn. The barn is not temperature controlled and the roll-up doors on the front and back walls are open during the day. This type of housing is considered outdoor housing and requires approval from USDA-Animal Care's Deputy Administrator. Documented approval to house guinea pigs outdoors could not be found in USDA's files for this facility and the facility representative did not respond to the inspector's phone calls to discuss this concern.

Housing guinea pigs in outdoor enclosures may subject the animals to uncomfortable or dangerous climatic conditions. Approval from the Deputy Administrator is necessary to ensure that local temperatures and weather conditions are reviewed and determined to be appropriate to protect the health and well-being of guinea pigs housed outdoors.

Guinea pigs shall not be housed in outdoor facilities unless such facilities are located in an appropriate climate and prior approval for such outdoor housing is obtained from the Deputy Administrator. The facility must not house the guinea pigs in outdoor enclosures unless approval from the Deputy Administrator has been acquired.

Correction date: 23-September-2026

3.28(a)

Primary enclosures.

One enclosure, housing nine guinea pigs, has a wire ramp that is used by the animals to access the upper section of their enclosure. The ramp is covered by a rubber mat, and the guinea pigs have excessively chewed and damaged the edges of the mat. Chewing on rubber may result in the inadvertent consumption of the rubber by the guinea pigs which could result in injury or serious health issues.

Primary enclosures shall be structurally sound and maintained in good repair to protect the guinea pigs from injury. The facility must alter the rubber mat in a manner that eliminates the risk of consumption and injury and the facility must also maintain the rubber mat in good repair. The facility must ensure the enclosures are safe for the guinea pigs at all times.

Correction date: 18-September-2026

Prepared By: KELLY MAXWELL
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care
Title: ANIMAL CARE INSPECTOR

Date:
09-SEP-2026

Received by Title: Facility Representative

Date:
09-SEP-2026



Inspection Report

3.28(a)(4)

Primary enclosures.

One enclosure, housing nine guinea pigs, has a wire ramp that is used by the animals to access the upper section of their enclosure. The ramp is covered by a rubber mat which has been heavily damaged by the guinea pigs. The rubber mat no longer covers the entire ramp and the exposed openings in the wire ramp are large enough to allow the feet of the guinea pigs to pass through. Openings in flooring that are large enough to allow feet and legs to pass through could cause injury or entrapment of the guinea pig.

Primary enclosures equipped with wire or mesh floors shall be constructed so as to protect the animals' feet and legs from injury. The facility must alter the wire ramp in a manner that does not allow the guinea pigs' feet to pass through and eliminates the risk of injury or entrapment. The facility must ensure the enclosures are safe for the guinea pigs at all times.

Correction date: 18-September-2026

3.31(b)

Sanitation.

The facility has a large red barn that it uses to house eleven guinea pigs. A metal fan is attached to a wall inside the barn across from the guinea pigs and is operating at the time of the inspection. The fan is covered in a heavy buildup of brown dirt and organic material. Failure to keep the fan clean may interfere with the movement of air which could have a negative impact on the animals during temperature extremes.

Premises (buildings and grounds) shall be kept clean and in good repair in order to protect the animals from injury and to facilitate the prescribed husbandry practices. The facility must clean the fan to ensure proper air movement to support the health and well-being of the guinea pigs.

Correction date: 18-September-2026

3.53(a)(1)

Primary enclosures.

The primary fencing of one outdoor rabbit enclosure, housing five rabbits, has chicken wire attached along the interior. Several sections of the chicken wire are broken and creating sharp points at the level of the rabbits. Sharp points could cause injury to the rabbits.

Primary enclosures shall be structurally sound and maintained in good repair to protect the rabbits from injury, to contain them, and to keep predators out. The facility must alter the broken chicken wire in a manner that eliminates the risk of injury to the rabbits. The facility must ensure the enclosures are safe for the animals at all times.

Correction date: 18-September-2026

3.53(a)(2)

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Primary enclosures.

The facility has a large concrete yard that contains three outdoor rabbit enclosures which house a total of seven rabbits. The rabbits are housed directly on the concrete floor along one side of the yard. The concrete yard slopes towards the rabbit enclosures and rain water flows from the yard directly through the rabbit enclosures. It had rained earlier in the morning and the majority of the flooring in each enclosure is wet and one rabbit was observed to have wet feet and some areas of wet hair on its back and rump. Failure of the enclosure to keep the rabbits dry may cause the animals discomfort as well as lead to further health issues.

Primary enclosures must be constructed and maintained so as to enable the rabbits to remain clean and dry. The facility must alter the enclosures in a manner that allows the rabbits to remain dry at all times.

Correction date: 23-September-2026

3.56(c)

Sanitation.

The facility has a large red barn that it uses to house one rabbit. A metal fan is attached to a wall inside the barn above the rabbit and is operating at the time of the inspection. The fan is covered in a heavy buildup of brown dirt and organic material. Failure to keep the fan clean may interfere with the movement of air which could have a negative impact on the animals during temperature extremes.

Premises (buildings and grounds) shall be kept clean and in good repair in order to protect the animals from injury and to facilitate the prescribed husbandry practices. The facility must clean the fan to ensure proper air movement to support the health and well-being of the rabbit.

Correction date: 18-September-2026

3.125(a)

Facilities, general.

A wood split rail fence is used as the primary fencing for one outdoor enclosure housing two goats. Small sections of metal fencing and orange mesh are attached to the interior of the primary fencing. Several areas of the metal fencing are broken and creating sharp points at the level of the goats. One metal section has become detached and is leaning away from the primary fence. The orange mesh attached to the interior of the wooden gate has become loose and wrapped around itself and the lower part of it is on the ground and can be stepped on by the goats.

The two goats use a barn as a shelter and the barn siding is attached to the frame with screws. Along the interior of the barn, the sharp ends of these screws are exposed and located at the level of the goats.

Another outdoor enclosure, housing eight goats, has a shelter that is constructed of metal siding. Along the bottom of at least one side of the shelter, the metal is broken and creating sharp points and jagged edges.

An additional outdoor enclosure, housing four goats, has a shelter constructed of metal siding. One edge of the siding is

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detached from the wooden frame and bent outward which is creating a sharp edge at the level of the goats.

Failure to keep metal and mesh fencing in good repair could cause injury to the animals or increase the risk of the animals becoming entangled. Sharp points and jagged edges could also cause injury to the animals.

The facility must be constructed of such material and of such strength as appropriate for the animals involved. Outdoor housing facilities shall be structurally sound and maintained in good repair to protect the animals from injury and to contain the animals.

The facility must alter the sharp points and jagged edges and the metal and mesh fencing in a manner that eliminates the risk of injury and entanglement to the animals. The facility must ensure the enclosures are maintained in good repair at all times.

Correction date: 18-September-2026

3.125(c)

Facilities, general.

A bag of milk replacer for one calf is stored in the refrigerator. The interior of the refrigerator is dirty, contains some rodent feces, and has several areas that are covered in a dark brown material. The facility representative stated that rats may have been getting into the refrigerator. Failure to store milk replacer in a clean refrigerator may result in contamination of the food item which could have a negative impact on the health of the calf.

Supplies of food and bedding shall be stored in facilities which adequately protect such supplies from deterioration, molding and contamination from vermin. The facility must provide a clean storage area for the milk replacer and ensure that all food items are compliantly stored at all times.

Correction date: The milk replacer was removed from the refrigerator at the time of the inspection.

3.131(c)

Sanitation.

The facility has a large red barn that it uses to house one hedgehog. A metal fan is attached to a wall inside the barn above the hedgehog and is operating at the time of the inspection. The fan is covered in a heavy buildup of brown dirt and organic material. Failure to keep the fan clean may interfere with the movement of air which could have a negative impact on the animals during temperature extremes.

Premises (buildings and grounds) shall be kept clean and in good repair in order to protect the animals from injury and to facilitate the prescribed husbandry practices. The facility must clean the fan to ensure proper air movement to support the health and well-being of the hedgehog.

Correction date: 18-September-2026

The outdoor enclosure, containing three cattle, has unused sections of metal fencing stored on top of wooden pallets and

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at least one roll of metal fencing on the ground. The cattle can come into direct contact with the stored fencing. Additionally, the primary fencing of the enclosure is overgrown with weeds making it difficult to determine if the fencing is maintained in good repair.

Unused fencing stored in primary enclosures could cause injury to the animals should they come into contact with the materials. Overgrown weeds could hide fencing that is in disrepair which could result in an injury or escape as well as attract pests such as mice which could increase the risk of disease hazards.

Premises (buildings and grounds) shall be kept clean and in good repair in order to protect the animals from injury and to allow the prescribed husbandry practices required by the Animal Welfare Act regulations. The facility must either remove the stored fencing or alter the enclosure in a manner that eliminates the ability of the animals to come into contact with the stored materials. The facility must also address the overgrown weeds in a manner that allows for observation of the fencing to ensure it remains in good repair.

Correction date: 25-September-2026

3.150(g)

Facilities, general.

One outdoor enclosure, housing one duck and one chicken, also contains a large tortoise. The tortoise has dug a hole in the corner of the enclosure that is full of water. The water is attracting insects to the enclosure, and a large number of insects are flying around the water and landing on the water. Failure of the facility to drain excess water from enclosures could make it difficult for the animals to stay dry as well as attract insects which could cause discomfort to the animals and increase the risk of disease transfer.

Housing facilities must be equipped with disposal and drainage systems that are constructed and operated so that animal waste and water are rapidly eliminated. The facility must drain the water from the hole in the chicken and duck enclosure. The facility must ensure that all enclosures have adequate drainage systems to rapidly eliminate any excess water to support the health and well-being of the animals.

Correction date: 09-October-2026

3.152(b)

Facilities, outdoor

One outdoor enclosure, housing ten large ducks and one goose, has only one plastic dog igloo as a shelter. The igloo is too small to contain all the birds at the same time. Additionally, four chickens are housed in an outdoor enclosure with no access to a shelter. It had rained earlier that morning and had stormed the previous afternoon.

Failure to provide an adequate shelter does not ensure the birds can escape inclement weather which could have a negative impact on their health.

Outdoor housing facilities must provide adequate shelter, appropriate to the species and physical condition of the birds, for the local climatic conditions to protect the birds from adverse weather conditions. Shelters must be constructed to

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provide sufficient space to comfortably hold all of the birds at the same time without adverse intraspecific aggression or grouping of incompatible birds.

The facility must either add more shelters for the ducks and goose or alter the plastic dog igloo in a manner that supplies sufficient space for all the birds at the same time. The facility must also add a compliant shelter to the chicken enclosure. The facility must ensure that all animals housed outdoors have compliant shelters at all times.

Correction date: 18-September-2026

3.153(a)

Primary enclosures.

One outdoor enclosure containing one rooster and approximately twenty ducks, has mesh attached to the interior of the primary fencing. The mesh has become detached in several areas and is hanging down into the enclosure at the level of the birds.

One outdoor enclosure containing five turkeys, one peacock and one peahen has wire mesh attached to the interior of the primary fencing. One end of the mesh has become detached and is bent inward at the level of the animals. The enclosure also contains a small wooden shelter which has fallen into disrepair and is leaning heavily to one side.

Failure to keep the mesh attached to the primary fencing could cause injury to the animals should they become entangled. Failure to keep shelters in good repair could cause injury to the animals should the shelter collapse.

Primary enclosures must be designed and constructed of suitable materials so that they are structurally sound. The primary enclosures must be kept in good repair. The facility must alter the detached mesh fencing and the wooden shelter in a manner that eliminates the risk of injury to the animals. The facility must ensure that all aspects of the primary enclosure are kept in good repair at all times.

Correction date: 18-September-2026

This inspection was conducted with the facility representative. The scheduled exit interview could not be conducted as the inspector was unable to make contact with the facility representative.

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Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
7257	72-C-0171	001	Morgan City Petting Zoo	01-SEP-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000011	<i>Guinea Pigs</i>	GUINEA PIGS
000008	<i>Oryctolagus cuniculus</i>	DOMESTIC RABBIT / EUROPEAN RABBIT
000020	<i>Capra hircus</i>	DOMESTIC GOAT
000002	<i>Ovis aries aries</i>	SHEEP INCLUDING ALL DOMESTIC BREEDS
000003	<i>Bos taurus</i>	CATTLE / COW / OX
000003	<i>Sus domestica</i>	DOMESTIC PIG
000001	<i>Lama glama</i>	LLAMA
000001	<i>Erinaceus concolor</i>	EASTERN EUROPEAN HEDGEHOG
000002	<i>Numida meleagris</i>	DOMESTIC GUINEAFOWL / HELMETED GUINEAFOWL / PEARL HEN
000005	<i>Meleagris gallopavo domesticus</i>	DOMESTIC TURKEY
000001	<i>Anser anser domesticus</i>	DOMESTIC GOOSE
000035	<i>Gallus gallus domesticus</i>	DOMESTIC CHICKEN (INCLUDING ALL DOMESTIC BREEDS / TURKIN / COCK / HEN / ROOSTER)
000025	<i>Anas platyrhynchos domesticus</i>	DOMESTIC DUCK INCLUDING ALL DOMESTIC BREEDS
000002	<i>Pavo cristatus</i>	INDIAN PEAFOWL / COMMON PEAFOWL / PEAHEN / PEACOCK
000119	Total	